

could a man with everything commit suicide? It was only when his financial affairs became known that people began to understand the truth. At Felix's funeral, people said they understood why he chose to stay silent. The pressure to be successful—or perhaps more to the point, not fail—was overwhelmingly echoed in that funeral parlor that day. Perhaps in Felix's death, he may have prevented another, as the room poured out their financial worries and problems to others for the first time.

If Felix's wife had been involved in the family finances, she would have noticed the irregular deposits and withdrawals due to his gambling habit. Then she could have taken steps to confront Felix on these transactions and hopefully uncover his gambling addiction. Once his addiction had come to light, she could have contacted Gamblers Anonymous groups who could have helped Felix, and by doing so saved his life.

It is noble to trust your spouse, but in Felix's wife's case, her blind trust enabled Felix to hide his addiction. Both partners should be actively involved in the family finances. One person might be assigned to do certain tasks, but full disclosure of the family's financial situation should be made known to all. Denying reality only makes the situation worse in the long run.

Words of Wisdom

Denial is only a temporary solution. Eventually you must confront the problem if it is ever to be resolved and go away. Denial of money problems is common if you don't feel in control of the situation. If you take the attitude that there is nothing that can be done, then your sense of futility prohibits you from working out a permanent solution.

People who feel powerless are in fact powerful if they confront the problem. The first step is to face the problem with total honesty and then, and only then, do solutions become apparent. Even if the solution is to lose everything

